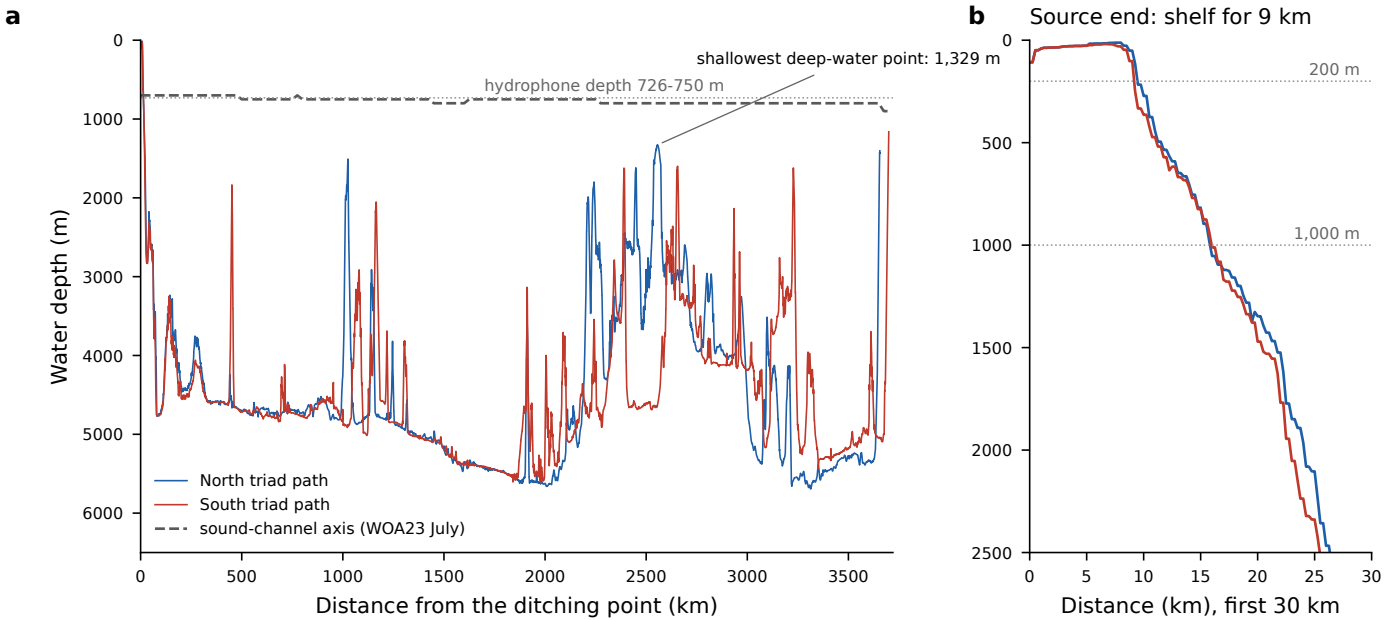
The 3,655-3,700 km paths to Wake Island stay in deep water; the only obstruction is the Oahu shelf at the source end, where the water stays shallower than 200 m for the first 9 km



(i) Plain language. The lines show the sea floor depth under the straight paths from the place where the aircraft went into the water to the two Wake Island stations. After the first 16 km the water is always deeper than 1,300 m, so the deep sound channel is open. Near Oahu the aircraft was on a shelf: the water is less than 200 m deep for the first 9 km of the path. This shelf decreases the sound that goes into the deep channel.
(ii) Technical. GEBCO_2026 15-arc-second (netCDF), WGS84 geodesics sampled every 250 m, centre-line depth; ±2 km corridor gives the same minimum beyond 30 km (1,329 m H11N at 2,555 km; 1,569 m H11S). No land on either corridor. Depth < 200 m for 9.3 km (H11N) / 9.0 km (H11S); > 1,000 m from 16.0 km. Channel axis = depth of minimum WOA23 B5C2 July sound speed (TEOS-10) at the 25-km nodes. Verdict by the project's line-of-sight rules: clear beyond the source shelf. GEBCO at the wreck 117 m against NTSB 104-111 m (340-364 ft). Module KRAKEN finds no modes at <= 40 Hz on this great circle (first 5-km profile 37 m); RAM gives 165-179 dB at 5-20 Hz (10 m source), 47-62 dB above the seaward-offset paths.